

Contemporary Mathematics

MATH 125 01 Fall 2026

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Course Documents

Syllabus

Instructor Information

Instructor	Christopher Servant
Pronouns	he/him
Phone Number	(989) 964-4894
Email	cservant@svsu.edu
Office	SW 340
Student Hours	

Monday	1:00 PM - 2:00 PM
Tuesday	12:00 PM - 2:00 PM
Wednesday	1:00 PM - 2:00 PM

Note: Please do not contact your instructor via Canvas. Only use his email or phone above.

Note: If you need a more private appointment to discuss grades or another personal matter, additional student hours can be made to meet in my office or via ZOOM.

Course Information

Course Dates	August 31, 2026 - December 19, 2026
Meeting Times	M, W: 2:30 PM - 4:20 PM
Location	Brown Hall 107
Credits	4
Meeting Times	M, W: 2:30 PM - 4:20 PM
Prerequisites	All Math Basic Skills or equivalent must be completed prior to taking this course. This is done by passing MATH 082 or MATH 072 with a C or higher.

Course Description

A liberal arts course providing an introduction to logical inference, statistics, probability, management science, social choice, concepts of size and shape,

algorithmic processes and consumer mathematics. Emphasis on understanding rather than computational expertise.

Course Materials

Text	<i>Math in Society</i> by David Lippman You can view an online copy of this free, open source textbook at Math in Society .
Three Ring Binder	This will be helpful to keep your notes and class work-sheets in.

Online Course Component

In this class, you will have access to course notes, lecture videos, handouts, deadlines, and announcements on Canvas. If you are absent or class is canceled due to weather or other circumstances, it is your responsibility to log on and obtain missed notes, work, etc. Grades will be updated periodically on Canvas. It is also important to check your SVSU email regularly.

Course Outcomes

This General Education course introduces fundamental algebraic terminology and skills; demonstrates how ingenuity and creativity are essential in developing mathematical models to solve real world problems; cultivates critical thinking and logical reasoning for effective problem solving and rational decision-making in a complex technological society; and develops communication skills for translating real world situations into symbolic mathematical relationships and for interpreting mathematical results within their real world contexts.

The following lists the set of outcomes covered in this course:

1. Graphs and Shortest Path
2. Euler and Hamiltonian Circuits
3. Spanning Trees
4. Plurality
5. Runoff Voting and Borda Count
6. Copeland's Method and Approval Voting
7. Weighted Voting and Power
8. Hamilton's, Jefferson's, and Webster's Methods
9. Huntington-Hill and Lowndes' Methods
10. Logic and Statements
11. Truth Tables and De Morgan's Laws
12. Scheduling
13. Simple and Compound Interest
14. Annuities and Loans

15. Sets, Venn Diagrams, and Cardinality
16. Statistics, Data, and Sampling Methods
17. Presenting Data Graphically
18. Measuring Data
19. Probability
20. Fractals

Evaluation

Video Notes For each section covered in class, students are required to submit completed notes based on the assigned lecture videos. One submission is required per section and is due before the start of class on the day that section is covered. Notes are graded on a 0–2 scale:

- 2:** Notes are submitted on time, are complete, and reflect engagement with the assigned videos.
- 1:** Notes are submitted on time but are missing significant portions.
- 0:** Notes are not submitted on time.

Notes are graded for completion only, not for correctness. No late submissions are accepted. Notes may be handwritten, typed, or completed on a tablet, but all submissions must be uploaded as a single PDF file. Students are expected to know how to scan or create a PDF of their notes; guidance will be provided as needed.

Worksheets Worksheets are completed during class and are intended to help students practice and apply the concepts being studied. Each worksheet is paired with a MyOpenMath assignment. Students are expected to answer the questions in MyOpenMath and show supporting work on the worksheet packet. Both the completed worksheet and completion of the associated MyOpenMath assignment are required for credit.

Students may collaborate with classmates while working on worksheets and may use their notes and classroom laptops. The use of cell phones, generative AI tools, or other unauthorized resources is not permitted. Worksheets are due at the end of class and may be submitted up until the beginning of the next class period without penalty. Worksheets submitted after the start of the next class period will not be accepted.

While correctness is primarily assessed through MyOpenMath, students are expected to show clear and meaningful work on their worksheet packets. Work that is incomplete, inconsistent with the submitted answers, or does not demonstrate an attempt to solve the problem may result in reduced credit.

Quizzes Quizzes are administered approximately every fourth class meeting throughout most of the semester. Quizzes assess a student's ability to independently apply the concepts and skills developed through class activities, worksheets, and assigned course materials.

Each quiz is scored on a 0-3 scale:

- 3:** Demonstrates a strong understanding of the outcome with little to no error. Work is complete, mathematically correct, and clearly communicates the solution process.
- 2:** Demonstrates substantial understanding of the outcome but contains one or more minor errors. The overall solution process is appropriate and most of the work is correct.
- 1:** Demonstrates partial understanding of the outcome but contains significant errors or omissions. Some correct work is shown, but the student has not yet demonstrated competency.
- 0:** The outcome is not attempted or the work submitted does not demonstrate an understanding of the outcome.

Each quiz includes two in-class attempts. For each quiz, the highest score earned across all attempts is used when calculating the Quiz portion of the course grade.

A third attempt is available only after attending tutoring. Students must work with a tutor to review the relevant worksheet problems and their first two attempts before a third attempt will be granted.

Quizzes are not given as make-ups. The multiple-attempt structure is intended to accommodate absences and scheduling conflicts. Students who miss an in-class attempt may use a remaining attempt to demonstrate competency.

For the final quizzes of the course, only one in-class attempt may be provided during the final exam period. Additional attempts must be completed outside of class time by appointment.

Grading

Your final course grade will be determined by your performance in three categories: Video Notes, Worksheets, and Quizzes. A letter grade will be determined separately for each category using the requirements below. Your final

course grade will be the lowest of the three category grades.

Video Notes

- A:** At least 90% of the video notes completed.
- B:** At least 80% but less than 90% of the video notes completed.
- C:** At least 70% but less than 80% of the video notes completed.
- D:** At least 60% but less than 70% of the video notes completed.
- F:** Less than 60% of the video notes completed.

Worksheets

- A:** At least 90% of the worksheets completed.
- B:** At least 80% but less than 90% of the worksheets completed.
- C:** At least 70% but less than 80% of the worksheets completed.
- D:** At least 60% but less than 70% of the worksheets completed.
- F:** Less than 60% of the worksheets completed.

Quizzes

- A:** At least 54 quiz points earned.
- B:** At least 48 but fewer than 54 quiz points earned.
- C:** At least 39 but fewer than 48 quiz points earned.
- D:** At least 30 but fewer than 39 quiz points earned.
- F:** Fewer than 30 quiz points earned.

Here are some examples showing how final course grades are determined:

1. A student completes 94% of the Video Notes, completes 92% of the Worksheets, and earns 56 Quiz points. The student earns an A in all three categories. Therefore, the student's final course grade is an A.
2. A student completes 95% of the Video Notes, completes 84% of the Worksheets, and earns 55 Quiz points. The student earns an A for Video Notes, a B for Worksheets, and an A for Quizzes. Since the lowest category grade is a B, the student's final course grade is a B.
3. A student completes 83% of the Video Notes, completes 74% of the Worksheets, and earns 51 Quiz points. The student earns a B for Video Notes, a C for Worksheets, and a B for Quizzes. Since the lowest category grade is a C, the student's final course grade is a C.

Course Notes

The following notes are intended to remind you what we covered each week. They are not a substitute for attending class and not a substitute for reading the textbook.

Notes 6.2: Graphs

Motivation

How to write solutions.

Wednesday 8/24

Friday 8/26

In-Class Activities

These are copies of the in-class activities distributed during the semester.

Introduction Activity

This is the introduction to the activity.

1. This is the first exercise.

Handouts

Handout Title

1. A first paragtretraph with some space for notes below it.

Homework

Homework 01

Instructions: Complete all the exercises below and submit your work by the due date.

1. This is the first homework exercise.